

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4 3
♥ J 4 3
♦ J 10 9
♣ 9 6 2

♠ A 9 6
♥ A Q 10
♦ Q 8 4
♣ K J 7 5



♠ K Q 2
♥ K 9 7 2
♦ K 7 5 3
♣ 10 3

♠ J 10 7
♥ 8 6 5
♦ A 6 2
♣ A Q 8 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

covered you would win the Ace then set up a second trick in the suit.) East wins with the ♠Q, and guess what?

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥2. West plays the ♥J which you win with the ♥Q.

You have one trick already in the bag, four more to come in ♣s, and three other Aces. So all you have to do is get one of those finesse positions to come through. By now, though, you must have figured that nothing is going to work! Even your best shot, West holding at least one of ♠K Q will not happen. The answer (again) is to eliminate, then throw in.

This time there is only one suit you can eliminate, ♣s. So play all four ♣s, ending in dummy. They split 3-2.

You now play the ♠J from dummy and let it ride when West follows with a low card. (If West had

HE IS ENDPLAYED!. He has no ♣s, and whichever other suit he plays will give you your ninth trick!

Wow! End-played at trick #6.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 3
 ♥ J 10 8 4
 ♦ K 10 6 2
 ♣ 10 2

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ 9 6

♦ J 5 4

♣ Q J 9 5



♠ 9 4
 ♥ Q 7 5 3 2
 ♦ A 9 3
 ♣ 8 6 3

♠ K J 6 5

♥ A K

♦ Q 8 7

♣ A K 7 4

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

South is to play 4♠ after North's Stayman bid uncovered the 4-4 fit. West leads the ♥J which you win the your ♥A.

With three possible losers in ♦s you might first think that you will have to finesse one of the defenders for the trump Queen. But anytime you see an unsupported Jack opposite an unsupported Queen you should start thinking about a throw-in play. And what better card to use for the throw-in than the Queen of trumps.

So pull two rounds of trumps with the ♠A and ♠K, hoping the ♠Q falls. She doesn't fall, but both defenders do follow suit. So the ♠Q is the only trump outstanding.

Next eliminate ♥s from you and dummy by playing the ♥K.

Now play four rounds of ♣s to eliminate that suit. If a defender decides to ruff one of these ♣s with the master trump he will be end-played, forced to either play a ♦ or to give you a ruff-sluff. So assume that all four ♣s win tricks.

Now you administer the coup de gras, you lead a trump.

[showcards N:ST,DJ,D5,D4 S:SJ,DQ,D8,D7]

One of the defenders has won the ♠Q. Too bad for him. If he now plays a ♦ you will make either the ♦Q or ♦J. If he plays a ♥ you will ruff in one hand and discard a ♦ loser from the other.

It is clear that the elimination play saved you having to guess the finesse for the ♠Q.

But what if you considered yourself a really good guesser? So good that you felt confident in taking the finesse, and so good that you pulled it off successfully.

You'd be no better off. Although you would avoid the ♠ loser you would now have to play the ♦s for yourself and you would lose three ♦s!